The Proposal

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39010038.

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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catradora, Two Year Shera Anniversary, Marriage Proposal, Healing, reflections of the past, Family, Finding Halfmoon Series, Implied Sexual Content, Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra)

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by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

A year has passed since the war ended. Catra's and Adora's relationship has blossomed to new heights. They have shared many beautiful moments, many unforgettable memories and many unbreakable promises. Adora wants to add to them all for the rest of her life... she just hopes Catra wants that too.

Notes

Hello Everyone. Happy two year anniversary to Dreamworks SheRa. Can you believe Catradora has been canon for two years?

This fic is the first prequel story of my new fic, Finding Halfmoon, that will have it's first official chapter posted tomorrow. Sorry for the delay in getting it sorted but better late than never. In the meantime I hope you enjoy the first prequel story and I hope you enjoy reading Finding Halfmoon too. Enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

'Come on Adora. You can do this. Deep breathes, there's nothing to be afraid off. This is Catra we're talking about. You love her, you'd do anything for her… you nearly died for her once so what are you even saying, Of Course you'd do anything for her…'

"Adora… how about a little help over here."

"Oh yeah sure. Sorry didn't see you there." Adora says as she nervously giggles. She walks over to the metal ledge and pulls Catra over the top, gazing lovingly at her girlfriend.

"You're doing it again." Catra says smirking at her now deeply blushing girlfriend.

"Doing what again?" Adora asks, her eyes look towards the ground in an attempt to avoid Catra's gaze. Adora gets lost looking Catra's beautiful eyes very easily. Now is *definitely not* the time to be getting distracted.

"Staring at me like you're head over heels for me. You might want to be careful Adora or people might start thinking that you like me."

"And what's wrong with being head over heels for the most beautiful person in the entirety of Etheria. Besides, you know I don't even wear heels so what you said can't really make much sense."

Catra lightly punches Adora's shoulder and they both start to laugh. Adora could have sworn she heard Catra call her an idiot under her breath. They both walk over to the rail and gaze upon the beautiful scenery surrounding them.

Where are they you ask? - The Fright Zone, more specifically their secret spot from when they were cadets in the Horde… The Watch Tower.

So much has change in the past year since the war ended and magic was restored to Etheria. Life began to bloom in all its glory.

The Rebellion was making great progress with the rebuilding of their kingdoms and neighbouring settlements. Scorpia even rightfully claimed hers back and planned to set up a refuge within her kingdom for members of the Horde who had nowhere to go. The Best Friend Squad started planning their *'Best Friend Squad Road Trip',* even taking a few little trips here and there, but much work had to be sorted before they could start their planned interstellar journey.

As for Adora and Catra, things have been amazing…. *well, that's not entirely true*. As much as their love for each other allowed them to heal in more ways than one, there have been a few challenges to say the least.

Not everyone was accepting of Catra after everything that happened throughout the war, even though most of her actions where a result of anger and fear. Some people were understanding of this but others were not. Non the less Catra was determined to make things right. She helped with the reconstruction of Salineas, helped smaller communities rebuild their homes and provided support for each and every kingdom when possible. She also made amends with Kyle, Lonnie and Rogelio; after all they were like family to both her and Adora, they'd practically grown up together. Glimmer even appointed Catra to the position of Brightmoon's royal advisor three months after the war ended due to her skills, loyalty and dedication. It was a real confidence booster for her and something she really deserved. Adora couldn't be more proud that her partner and one of her best friends were working together to build a brighter future.

As for Adora, she's began to understand that She-Ra is a part of who she is and it's about time people saw her that way. Adora was She-Ra, not just the embodiment of She-Ra. She learnt how to identify when her body needed to rest, even if the first few times Catra had to *'drag her ass to bed'* as she always put it. She started to make more time for herself, for Catra and the Best Friend Squad. It was the best thing she'd ever done.

Although, despite all the good times there was still the matter of the big looming cloud over their heads that still to this day causes some nightmares to occur. Therapy was something they agreed to go through individually and together. The trauma both Adora and Catra have suffered, not only through the war but throughout their younger days as cadets in the Horde, has left many scars on them. Some scars are visible like Adora's deep claw marks and Catra's chip scar. Other scars were invisible to those who didn't wear them and it took a lot of time for both to gain the courage to discuss them. Catra had particularly struggled to open up about her past at first, mainly because there was some things that Adora was unaware of. This was usually thanks to Shadow Weaver's mind wiping abilities. Catra would be forced to watch Adora's mind be erased only to be left with the guilt and upset of being the only one to remember the memory. However, with some much needed encouragement from Adora and her trusty companion Melog, progress was made and Catra slowly started to heal. Discussing Prime was a difficult one for them both but more so for Catra, but per her request, Adora was always by her side when it came to discussing him. After each therapy session, both girls left feeling lighter and relieved, but their nightmares were still waiting for them when they went to sleep. Some nights were better than others. In the earlier months, some nightmares were so traumatic that both Adora and Catra would stay awake with each other all night, holding each other close, whispering soft words to each either, neither wanting to let go first. They'd only fall asleep when they were both incredibly exhausted, tangled up together under the bed sheets. The nightmares and panic attacks have decreased over time but when they occurred they struck hard. Despite all this, one thing remained certain. Catra and Adora loved each other. Their love is unbreakable. No matter how long the nights are, no matter how difficult the days seemed, they were always there for each, and they will always be there for each other… which brings them to this moment.

"It's beautiful isn't it?" Catra says as she takes in the view from above, Adora's hand placed lovingly over hers. "I never imagined

that a place filled with so much darkness so long ago, would grow to be something so wonderful."

Catra was right. The Fright Zone had changed a lot. If Adora wasn't so nervous right now she probably would have been listening to what Catra had been saying, but right now her heart was racing and her hands were shaking.

"Hey, you okay?" Catra asks, slightly turning to face Adora with concern.

"*Yeah I'm fine… Totally fine… W-why wouldn't I be?"* Adora can't help but stutter through her words. She's nervous.

Catra moves away from the rail ledge and moves to hold both of Adora's hands firmly in hers. Their eyes meet instantly. Catra can see Adora's worry in her eyes, but there is also a sense of love… *what on Etheria is going on with Adora?*

"Adora your hands are shaking. Scrap that, I can feel your whole body trembling under that *stupid* jacket of yours. Do I need to mention that you seemed very distracted when I asked if you could pull me up here? You've been acting strange all day. Please Adora, tell me what's on your mind. I'm worried about you. You know that nothing you can say is ever going to change the way I feel about you. You're stuck with me for life, whether you like it or not."

Adora would very much like to be with Catra for the rest of her life.

Adora's body starts to relax and her thumbs start drawing small circular patterns over the top of Catra's hands… "Promise?"

"I promise."

"Catra… I need to ask you something."

--

****Earlier that day****

Staring down at her golden wing pin in her hand, Adora smiles to herself. She's never felt so sure about anything in her life. Adora has known for a long, *long* time that she wanted to be with Catra forever, to spend the rest of her life with her. Adora had spoken to Netossa and Spinnerella about something called marriage a while ago. It came up after they had shown her and Catra their wedding photos when they visited them on one of their many couples adventures. It was the first time either of them had heard of such a thing so Adora being Adora went to do a bit of extra research on the topic. She spoke to all the married people she knew on Etheria: Netossa and Spinnerella, George and Lance, and even Micah. One thing she learnt from them all was that marriage is a fancy term for a lifetime commitment to the one person you truly love… *a universal promise*. Catra and Adora have been making promises to each other all their lives, so this technically was just an extension of their promises to each other. Adora knew she was ready for this. She always knew that she wanted to spend the rest of her life with Catra… she just hoped that Catra wants that too.

Adora suddenly feels a slight nudge on the lower part of her leg. When she looks down she finds Melog seeking her attention before meowing at her as if to ask, *"what you got there?"*

Adora smiles and crouches down to their level. She gives Melog a good scratch behind their ears, resulting in them purring in delight.

"What do you think Melog?" Adora whispers, showing them her golden wing pin… "I'm going to propose to Catra today. I've been wanting to propose for a while and today I feel ready. Do you think she'll approve of my wing pin?"

Melog sniffs the pin in Adora's hand before making a *mreow* noise in response and licking her cheek like they have done so many times before. Adora can't help but lightly giggle. She'll take that as a yes. Adora might not be able to communicate with Melog like Catra can but she has come to form a special connection with their Krytian friend.

The bed sheets start to rustle and Adora hears a low grumble come from under them. Adora has always been a slightly earlier riser compared to Catra. Catra has stated her dislike in this and Adora has started to stay in bed with her for a while longer, cuddling up to her girlfriend, content with each other's company.

Adora looks back at Melog and smiles. "Wish me luck," she says before clipping her wing pin to her belt like she usually does. If Catra isn't to suspect anything out the ordinary Adora's best going about her day as *normal* as possible.

Adora gets up and walks over to the bed before gently sitting beside her slowly waking girlfriend. Catra is lying on her stomach, the stripes on her arms and top of her back are visible. Adora starts to trace the stripes on Catra's back. Her only response is a *'murp'* sound. Catra is in every way beautiful to Adora. She can't even begin to understand how she ended up so lucky getting to live her life with her best friend, her girlfriend, *and hopefully soon to be fiancé.*

Sensing that Catra is still in the slight phase between semi-sleep and semi-awake Adora gently blows against her ear, which causes it to twitch. Still that doesn't work in getting her girlfriend to wake up. Time to turn it up a notch.

Adora starts to massage Catra's shoulders rather than tracing her stripes. The soothing effect causes Catra to purr. Adora's heart warms. She leans down to whisper in Catra's ear in a singsong voice… *"Catra. It's time to wake up."*

That sort of works, although Catra chooses to respond by trying to paw Adora away from her ear. Adora can sense that Catra is

more awake now as she hears her starting to grumble in annoyance.

Adora lightly laughs. She knows how to get Catra to wake up for sure now. Moving away from the cheery voice, Adora blatantly says… "The quicker you wake up the quicker you get morning kisses."

That gets Catra's attention. She turns to face Adora and her eyes slowly start to open. She slow blinks a few times. Her sleepy smile radiates their room… *"Hey Adora."*

"Oh good you're awake. My next step was to have Melog pounce on you."

That earns a sleepy chuckle from Catra and a curious meow from Melog, who has decided to joined the duo curling up at the foot of their bed.

"They say you'd have to give them some of their favourite treats to get them to do that. Besides, you know I can't say no to your kisses, which I believe was in the agreement for me waking up."

Adora giggles and leans down to passionately kiss her girlfriend.

"Why are you up and dress so early anyway? I thought you'd be all tired out from last night."

Adora blushes bright red knowing exactly what Catra means. It's enough to make Catra laugh. Adora loves Catra's laugh so much, it's one of the many things she loves about her. Catra rolls over, her back now resting against the bed. The covers only just cover the lower half of Catra's chest, her collarbone and shoulders are left exposed. Adora can see definite marks there from last night's antics.

Focus Adora.

"Well, even if I am slightly tired after last night, which was amazing by the way, I have some very important things I have to

attend?”

“Important you say? Why haven’t you told me about this.”

“It’s, *urm,* well it’s a surprise.”

“A surprise? Adora, you’re really bad at surprises.”

“I am not!”

“You are too! Do you remember what happened at Sparkles’s birthday party?”

Oh does she remember. They’d planned for a big celebration that the star siblings agreed to attend. Sadly Adora had blurted it out to Entrapta who then announced it to Glimmer when she went to visit Entrapta for and update on Darla when making preparations for the *‘Best Friend’s Squad Road Trip.’* Ah well they still had a fun night and there were other surprises in store that Catra and Bow deliberately didn’t tell Adora about in case something like that was to happen again.

Adora grumbles in defeat which causes Catra to snicker.

“Alright fair play. I apologised anyway. Besides, I promise you that this surprise will be worth it, but I can’t tell you about it till later.”

“Alright, but on one condition. You promise not to do anything stupid. Promise?”

And she calls Adora the overprotective one.

“I Promise.”

“Thank you. Now can I please have a goodbye kiss before you go.”

“Well considering you said please…”

As Adora leans down to kiss Catra goodbye, Catra grabs Adora’s jacket lapels and drags her back into bed. Adora ends up in a fit

of laughter whilst Catra makes herself comfy, laying lovingly on top of girlfriend. Her head rests on Adora's chest, her arms wrap around her waist, her tail tightly curls around her thigh. This is Adora's version of heaven.

"Stay with me till I'm fully awake?"

It seems to be more of a demand than a question but Adora couldn't care less either way. She goes to protest but Catra's *'kitten eyes'* and purring make her cave. Adora snuggles into Catra's hold before gently kissing her on the forehead.

"I love you Catra."

"I love you too dummy."

Adora definitely wants to wake up like this every morning for the rest of her life.

--

Adora walks into Brightmoon's kitchens to get a quick snack before she starts planning how and where to propose. It's the first time Adora doesn't feel like she has to fully plan this moment out as she feels confident about proposing to Catra... *okay that's a complete lie*. She's a bundle of excitement and nerves. Adora has been planning some steps leading towards this moment, but it's not like she's done a flow chart for it… *okay that's another lie*, but still it's better to be prepared that not prepared. Adora's been preparing for this day for months but today is the day that feels right to her. Either way, proposing to Catra isn't what's worrying her. What's worrying her is understanding how to make this moment perfect.

Adora grabs some warm toast before making her way out of the kitchens and down the corridor. Maybe speaking to Glimmer and

Bow will give her an idea of how to do this.

***GLITTER POOF * -** *Speak of the devils and they shall appear.*

Glimmer and Bow seem to be in the middle of one of their usual *'childish debates'*. Last one was about which of Bow's archery tech was the best, the other was whether or not Glimmer should dye her hair bright pink. Adora wonders what this morning's debate is about.

Bow and Glimmer come to a halt when they notice Adora looking at them in amusement.

"Morning Adora." Bow says in his usually cheery voice.

"Adora, perfect timing. We need you to solve a debate for us."

Of course Glimmer has to ask Adora something when she has a mouthful of toast. She nods to get her to ask her question anyway. She's almost finished eating.

"Which cake is better? Chocolate cake or Sponge Cake?"

Glimmer gives Adora a stern look as if to warn Adora to pick the *'right'* answer. She better tread carefully or she'll never hear the end of it.

"Why not both?" Adora asks with caution.

"See that's exactly what I said. But Glimmer here is instant that chocolate reigns supreme. I said any cake is good cake… unless its carrot cake. For some reason carrot cake does not agree with me."

Glimmer and Bow start to continue the little debate between themselves. Adora loves that her best friends are like this. It's one of the many things she loves about them. Adora would love to stay and help them solve their debate but right now she needs to sort stuff out for tonight and time is against her.

"Guys, I now this little debate of yours is *really important*, but I could really use your advice on something that's stressing me a little bit."

Glimmer and Bow look to Adora with great concern. It's not often that Adora comes to them asking for help. Sure therapy has helped her to open up a bit more but she still sometimes struggles to ask for help or advice when needed.

"What's wrong? Are you okay? Do you need me to punch someone because believe me I may be the queen of Brightmoon but I will fight anyone who upsets my best friend."

"*Okay* Glimmer, maybe try and calm down a little bit. What can we help you with Adora?"

Adora loves how protective and caring her friends are. They've become like family to her. They look out for each other. Truth be told she'd probably be lost without them.

"Okay. Well you see… I've decided that today…"

BANG, GUSH

"DID SOMEONE SAY SWIFTWIND!"

The best friend squad jump out of their skin at the sight and sound of Swift Wind barging through the window and announcing his presence. He's always had a flare for making a dramatic entrance but this certainly tops them all so far.

"Urgh no. But it's good to see you Swift Wind. What are you doing coming in through the window anyway? You know you can enter the castle at the front right?" Adora says as she moves to give her trusty steed a stroke on his head.

"I know but you know me and dramatic entrances. Besides, I could sense through our sacred bond that something is bothering you. I wanted to make sure that you where okay." Swift Wind

nuzzles into Adora's touch. Their bond has always been one of a kind.

"Awww thanks Swifty. I promise you that I'm okay. I'm just a little nervous about something that I was just about to ask Glimmer and Bow for advice on."

Just then Micah appears from around the corner, obviously alerted by the sound of something, or rather someone, crashing through the window. The sight of the best friend squad and She-Ra's overly dramatic flying horse tells him all he needs to know. Micah chuckles to himself and approaches the group.

"I should have known. Good morning all. How are we today?"

Micah moves closer to the group and pulls his daughter into a gentle hug from the side in greeting. Having Micah back in Brightmoon has been good for Glimmer. She's lost so much during the war and became someone she wasn't. It took a long time for some to forgive her but deep down they all knew that it wasn't really her. She was acting out of grief and anger, trauma can do that to you. Catra and Adora know that all too well. Having Micah back allowed Glimmer to heal quicker than expected. Their father-daughter bond makes Adora smile.

"Morning Dad. Adora has something troubling her and came to ask us for advice."

"Really, she came to you for advice? Adora are you sure that's a wise idea?" Micah teases. Adora and Bow giggle under their breath whilst Glimmer pretends to act insulted. "Very well. I'll leave you all be unless you want me input too Adora."

"That would actually be amazing. I could really use some advice from someone who has had experience with this kind of stuff before."

Glimmer, Bow, Micah and Swift Wind all look at Adora with a hint of curiosity and confusion. They wait for her to proceed. Adora takes a few deep breathes to steady for thoughts. Her hand lands

on her wing pin attached to her belt, her thumb gently stoking over it.

“I want to propose to Catra, tonight.”

For a moment the group are silent. A first it worries Adora until Glimmer throws her arms around her and practically squeals in delight. Bow proceeds to do the same, once he manages to stop his eyes from tearing up that is.

“It’s about time. I’m honestly surprised you haven’t proposed sooner.” Glimmer say, as she loosens her grip on Adora’s shoulders.

“I’m so happy for you guys.” Bow's practically trying to hold back tears. He’s the more emotional of the two friends but it’s just another thing Adora likes about Bow, he’s not afraid to show true emotion.

“So what seems to be worrying you Adora? Do you not have something to propose with?” Micah asks. He can see right through Adora. Micah has become like a father figure her to, giving her guidance and advice when needed.

“Oh no I do. I’m going to propose with this”. Adora lifts her wing pin off her belt showing it off before attaching it back to its original place… “I knew what I was going to propose with for a long time. I got my pin when I joined the Rebellion. It symbolizes new beginnings, the next chapter of our story. Catra loves it. Sometimes, when its sunny, I use it to shine a light up the wall and Catra goes crazy trying to catch it. I feel that this is the perfect engagement gift.”

Despite Adora’s smile she suddenly goes quite. Swift Wind gently nudges her arm with the tip of his nose, reminding her that he is beside her should she need to get away or comforting. Adora smiles at him and strokes his mane in thanks.

“I’m worried she might say no. I’m not even sure if Catra want’s this… wants to marry me… wants to spend the rest of her life with

me.”

The group sense what Adora’s getting at. They look to each other and smile, but then Bow starts to laugh when he sees Glimmer roll her eyes.

“*I am not trained to deal with useless lesbians.*” Glimmer groans and she face plants her hand against her head. She places her hands on either side of Adora’s shoulders and looks her directly in the eyes… “Adora, Catra loves you more than anything in the entirety of Etheria. There’s no questioning that. Your love for each other is one of the most powerful kinds of love in the universe. I’m not just talking about the fact that you literally saved Etheria with your love for each other, I’m on about the love you’ve had for each other since you were kids. She’s you best friend Adora, quite possibly your soulmate.”

Bow comes up to the side of Glimmer and Adora and places a hand on both of their shoulders… “This is a big step forward in yours and Catra’s relationship. Only time will tell what will happen. But Glimmer is right, your love for each other is unique. You’re meant to be together. Besides, as scary at this may seem, I really think Catra will surprise you, but you don’t know until you ask.”

Bow looks to Glimmer before they both softly giggle. Adora isn’t sure if there is an inside joke or a hidden message in Bow's words but she doesn’t care right now. They share a group hug.

“You know, I was probably just as nervous as you when I proposed to Angella.” Micah says, getting the groups attention.

“Really?” Adora asks out of curiosity.

“Yes really. Just ask my sister, Glimmer’s Aunt Casta. She’ll tell you that I was a nervous wreck for days. I wanted to make sure that everything was perfect. It took me forever to figure out what to propose to her with. I even thought of fancy undergarments at one point but decided that’s probably not the best idea. I was good at sorcery in my youth but not gift giving.”

Glimmer goes bright red with embarrassment. She clearly hasn't heard her parents engagement story before. Meanwhile, Adora and Bow try and hold back their laughter and wait for Micah to continue... "I eventually settled on a set of earrings that had been handed down to me from my ancestors for many generations. Eventually they will become Glimmers, should Bow choose to propose at some point."

"Dad! We are not discussing this in front of everyone. Besides me and Bow have only been dating for less than a year. Sure we've known each other since we were kids but we've only been officially dating for nine months."

Adora notices Bow's cheeks turn bright red and his body stiffen. *Was Bow planning on proposing to Glimmer?* She made a mental note to ask him later.

"Anyway I had planned a light show at Mystacor after many failed attempts of trying to set a date to propose to Angella. Everytime I tried I got too nervous to ask her. Casta promised to never make me a sweater again if I set an official date to propose. That was all the encouragement I needed. Her sweaters are very itchy. Back to the story, everything was set and ready but I hadn't accounted for the slight rainy weather that occurred the day before I had arrange to propose. I remember getting down on one knee during the fireworks display when I suddenly slipped down the hill, covering myself in mud. Angella flew down to rescue me as I got stuck in a mud puddle at the bottom. It was funny but I was still embarrassed. I was certain at that moment in time that she'd say no. She'd see me as a fool and reject me there and then. But I knew I loved this woman and that I wanted to marry her from the moment I met her. When she said yes my heart skipped a beat and the rest is history. My point is, it doesn't matter where you propose, when you propose or what you propose with. All that matters is that you're together and you enjoy the moments in life that you have together."

Glimmer has a shine of tears in her eyes and a bright smile on her face after hearing the story. Adora looks back to Micah and

whispers her words of thanks. Glimmer interrupts her thoughts… "So, where are you thinking about proposing?"

Adora blushes a little... "Well I have an idea, but I need to double check first. I'm going to…"

"Hey Adora."

Adora jumps a mile high, lips sealed tightly shut as Catra and Melog appear from around the corner... "What are you guys talking about"

Swift Wind being the character he is nearly ruins the surprise...

"Oh Adora was just telling us how…" Adora slaps her hands over the alicorns mouth and nervously laughs before giving her animal companion a stern look. At first he looks confused but then her gets the idea.

"Telling you guys what?" Catra slyly asks, leaning in close to her girlfriend making her flustered.

"Telling them how I'm… *how I'm…* going out for a little bit to try some new loopy-loop tricks with Swift Wind. It's been a long time since we hung out on a one-on-one bonding session and we don't want our sacred bond to be less-sacred you know."

Catra looks at Adora confused but doesn't question it. Melog mewls besides her, as if telling Catra not to worry. Adora makes a mental note to make sure Melog gets their favourite treats later for helping her out.

"Okay well just be careful. If you come home with any broken bones your talking horse there will be missing a wing."

"Hey I'm right here you know."

Catra lightly giggles at Swift Wind before stroking his mane. It took a while for Catra to warm up to Swift Wind, but in her defence he is very protective of Adora. It's one trait that they

have in common. They're very good friends now. Melog and Swift Wind are especially good friends too. Adora and Catra loves to watch them play together when they all go to visit Madam Razz in the Whispering Woods. Speaking of which, Razz did say something a few days ago about a union of love occurring soon. Adora knows Razz sometimes talks in riddles but she can't help but think that her words mean something. She'll have to go and see her after her proposal to Catra… *if all goes well that is.*

"Alright well you better get going. Oh by the way, me and Melog are going to visit Scorpia later on if you want to join us."

"Great. I'll see you there."

Adora said it before she could stop herself. *Shit, Catra wasn't meant to know Adora planned on seeing Scorpia today.* Catra looks at her confused but pushes her worries aside. Before Adora can let anything else slip up, she kisses Catra goodbye and mounts Swift Wind.

"You ready Swifty?"

"You bet."

They charge through the window and take off into the distance.

Catra turns back to Glimmer and Bow, noticing them snickering... "What's gotten into you two?"

"Oh nothing. Oh but why you're here, Bow and I need to ask you something important."

"Okay?" Catra says sceptically whilst looking towards Melog for answers.

"Which is better: Chocolate Cake or Sponge Cake."

Well Catra definitely didn't expect to be asked that this morning but she knows her answer straight away… "One hundred percent chocolate cake."

“What? Noooooooooooo!” Bow looks saddened with defeat.

“Yes! Told you so. Catra I owe you one. How about a piece of cake. I’m sure there’s some left in the kitchen.”

“Not going to say no to that Sparkles.”

Catra, Bow, Glimmer and Melog all walk down towards the kitchen to get some cake. Along the way Catra asks… “by the way, is it just me or does Adora seem to be acting a little weird to you today?”

Bow and Glimmer look at each other before giggling.

“Adora? Seems perfectly fine to me.” Bow says before chuckling.

“Yeah. Maybe she’s just *madly* in love with you.” Glimmer teases.

Catra looks at her friends clearly confused. Melog nudges her leg… *“Fear not friend. Your mate is simply arranging stuff that she was telling you about earlier.”*

Catra knows Melog is right but she still can’t help but worry about the woman she loves.

Up above, Adora and Swift Wind glide across the Whispering Woods… “Phew, that was a close one. Alright Adora, where to?”

“Spinnerella’s and Netossa’s place please. There’s something I want to ask them.”

--

Many loopy-loops later, *one slightly to many for Adora*, they arrive at Spinnerella and Netossa’s house. They live in a small house just outside of Elberon. Their home needed a bit of work doing thanks

to damage sustained over the course of the war, but Catra and Adora enjoyed pitching in to help them out.

Adora dismounts Swift Wind, her hand rubs her head as her feet hit the ground. *Yep, definitely one too many loopy-loops for her.*

"Whoooo! That was awesome. I haven't spread my wings like that in so long. I almost forget what it felt like. How about round two later when we're on our way to see Scorpia. What do you say Adora?... Urm Adora, are you okay? You don't look so good."

Swift Wind nudges his companion besides him. Adora is still feeling a bit dizzy but the nausea is wearing off now she's back on the ground.

"You think? I think that might have been one too many loopy-loops for me today Swift Wind. I think we'll just be going for a casual fly to Scorpia's later okay. I'd rather not be wanting to vomit when I propose to Catra. Can you imagine how embarrassing that would be."

Swift Wind grunts in disappointment but accepts that Adora is probably right… "Causal fly it is then. Just give us a shout when you're ready to head over to Scorpia's place. I won't be to far away. I'll just be over there, by that apple tree, taste testing… okay see you later Adora!"

Off Swift Wind goes to fill his stomach with apples. Adora can't help but laugh. There's no denying that Swift Wind really loves apples. Adora approaches the front door but as she goes to knock she hear a commotion coming from behind the house.

"Ha! Five-Four. One more shot and I win Spinny!"

"Oh it's on darling. Hope you're prepared to lose."

Adora walks through the back gate and into the garden. Her suspicions are confirmed . The couple are playing a game of netball in their backyard. Adora and Catra sometimes team up against them when they have free team and can come for a

friendly match. In the early days, Spinnerella and Netossa would always win but that's only because Catra and Adora didn't know how to play. With a little bit of practice and determination, the pair became quite the competition for the other wives. As much as Adora enjoys playing netball with Catra and the others, she much more preferred sparring with her. Sparring has always been a her and Catra's thing. Once it was a form of training, now it's a fun past time activity that often leads to *other fun activities*.

"Hey guys. How you doing?"

"Oh hey Adora. Didn't see you there." Says Netossa as she net swings the ball back over to Spinnerella.

"Adora, how nice to see you. We're good thanks." Spinnerella responds as she forms a strong gust of wind, powering the ball back to Netossa… "How you been?"

"Glad to hear it. I've been good thanks. Hope you don't mind the intrusion but I thought I'd pop by as… *well…* I kind of wanted to ask for your advice on something if that's okay with you."

As Adora speaks Netossa 'slam-dunks' the ball back over Spinnerella's side of the net. Spinnerella misses and Netossa's cheers… "WINNER! Better look next time dear."

"I let you win." Spinnerella responds coming to stand beside her wife and kissing her on the cheek... "Ask away Adora. We're more than happy to help you with anything we can."

Just like before, Adora's hands moves to her wing pin attached on her belt. Something about that simple movement provides her with all the courage she needs to speak… "I'm planning on proposing to Catra, tonight."

Netossa looks shocked by the statement. Her jaw drops as if she wasn't expecting to hear that. Spinnerella on the other hand looks at her with a cheesy grin. *Has Adora missed something? Was telling them not the best idea? Is she rushing into things?*

Spinnerella places an open hand out in front of her wife and Netossa hands her a small hand fully of cash. *Did they place a bet on Adora proposing to Catra?*

"Did you… did you guys place a bet on when I would propose to Catra?"

"Not exactly." Replies Netossa. Spinnerella chuckles slightly besides her *'disappointed'* wife.

"Netossa and I had a bet going on who would propose first. Netossa placed a bet on Catra as apparently *"she is always the one to make the first move".* Those were Netossa's exact words*.* I on the other hand said it would be you because *"your strong desires will eventually push you in the right direction*." Face it, you two are the younger versions of ourselves: you can't live without the other. Besides, we're not the only ones who placed a little bit like this."

Wait, What?

"Are you serious?" Adora asks, slightly amused but also shocked. *How was she this oblivious?*

"Of course she's serious Adora. You should know by now that Spinny can't lie to save her life. The main bet going was *when* one of you would propose to the other. I think the closest person to winning that bet is Glimmer. The only reason Spinny and I didn't bet on that one was because there might have never been a clear winner. Hence the bet between ourselves to guess who would propose first."

Adora has to admit that it was quite funny. She always knew that Catra was the one for her but she didn't think her friends would place bets on silly things like this.

"Anyway now that that's cleared up and out in the open, what was it you wanted to ask us Adora?" Spinnerella asks. She's always been easy to approach with her warm and comforting words. Adora knows that she can ask them both anything and never fear

being judged. It's one of the main reason why she always came to ask Spinnerella and Netossa for advice if something concerning was on her mind. Sure she would always speak to Catra about it but sometimes she need to speak to them too. She knew Catra was the exact same.

"I… *well I… *sighs*…* I want to make this proposal perfect. Catra… she means everything to me. She deserves the best and I want to give her the best. It's why I need to make tonight perfect. The only problem is I'm not quite sure how to do that."

Spinnerella and Netossa both look at Adora with hearts in their eyes. Of course she wants this proposal to be perfect. They both deserve for their proposal to go smoothly but the wives know far too well from experience that '*perfect*' doesn't always go according to plan. Spinnerella looks at Netossa with an encouraging smile. Netossa understands and directs Adora to sit with them on the patio decking chairs. At first Adora is confused but follows their lead.

"Adora, have we ever told you the story about how our proposal went?" Netossa asks, holding her wife's hand tightly as she sits beside her. Adora shakes her head and Netossa continues. Adora gets the feeling that is going to be a fun story…

"We were young, much younger than we are now. If I remember correctly we weren't much older than yourself and Catra at the time. I had been with Spinny for about a year and a half and yet I knew from the moment I met her that I was going to marry her. I knew exactly how I was going to propose and where I was going to ask her to marry me. We met playing netball in our late teen years at a small court that a few of our friends, Bow's dads George and Lance, set up on the beaches of Salineas. I asked her if she would go out with me on that beach, we had our first date on that beach, and we shared our first kiss at that beach. Therefore I knew that if I was going to make my proposal perfect, I was going to make another special memory by proposing at that very same beach. I got the netball court ready. I had my speech prepared. George and Lance were in on my plan and had agree to

challenge us two vs two. The game was going well. Spinny and I were winning. I gave George and Lance the signal; I got down on one knee behind Spinnerella and was ready to propose. Nothing could stop me…" Spinnerella starts to giggle leaving Adora wanting to hear more… "George served the ball and Spinny went to hit it back, but her ankle gave way and she feel to the side. Next thing I knew ***BAM*** the ball hit me in the face and I was out like a light."

Spinnerella bursts out with laughter, tears streaming down her face. Adora tries so hard to keep her laughter in but she can't. She's never heard this story before and she'll admit it might be one of her favourites about the duo so far. Netossa giggles to herself not long after, remembering the fond memory of that day herself.

"What happened after that?" Adora eagerly asks, wanting to know how the story ends, even though the ending is very clear to see. Netossa looks to her wife, allowing her to finish the story.

"Well, George and Lance ran over to help me up and it's only at that moment that I noticed what had happened to Netossa. Lance ran off to the sea to get a small handful of water which he then poured onto poor Netossa's face. She wasn't overly impressed but it did help her regain consciousness. Thankfully the only damage she obtained was a bruised eye. If she had gained a concussion I would have thought what happened next was a mistake."

Spinnerella looks at Netossa silently asking her to finish the story. After all, it is Netossa who propose to Spinnerella so it's only right that she finishes the story…

"I managed to shift myself out of Spinny's arms and onto one knee. I removed my necklace and placed it in her hands and asked her if she would honour me the pleasure of being my wife. As you can guess she said yes. We were married in the late autumn the year after and we've been together for nearly twenty years."

Netossa kisses her wife on the cheek and leans back into Spinnerella's embrace. Adora's heart warms at the sight. She hopes that one day she'll be able to tell someone the story of how she proposed to Catra and how their love for each other literally saved Etheria, but that'll be a story for future Adora and Catra. Right now she just has to hope that Catra say yes.

When Netossa notices Adora fiddling with her wing pin badge she leans forwards and rests a gently hand on Adora's knee… "I guess what we're trying to say is that somethings are out of our control. We can plan ahead of time, we can prepare to make things as *'perfect'* as possible. However, life sometimes has different plans for us. Besides, perfection isn't the most important thing when it comes to proposing. Love is the most important factor. As long as you love each other, which you both clearly do, that's all that matters."

Adora suddenly feels full of emotion. She has to fight herself to hold back tears, which she only just about manages. Netossa and Spinnerella guide Adora into a warm embrace. She chats with them for a few more minutes, telling them what her plans are and how she hopes things would go. Talking helps Adora to get some of her worries off her mind but there is still one more person she needs to speak to first. Eventually, Swift Wind shows up, claiming that he has had his fill of apples and reminds Adora that they should probably get going to their next destination before a *certain someone* arrives there. Adora and Swift Wind says their goodbyes and leave the wives in peace. As they get ready to take off Adora can hear the wives muttering behind her:

"So are we placing bets on when the wedding will be?"

"Darling, the poor girl hasn't even proposed yet?"

"Come on Spinny, we both clearly know what Catra's answer will be."

Adora smiles to herself as she and Swift Wind glide across the Whispering Wood and make their way to a place that has become

almost unrecognisable.

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The Fright Zone has transformed since the last time Adora was here. *It's so green.* Life is practically flourishing. The main structures are still standing but flowers and vines grow up and over them. Adora makes sure to ask Swift Wind to fly past the proposal location she has in mind to make sure it's safe before deciding that this is where she is going to propose to Catra. Thankfully it's safe. All she needs to do now is find Scorpia. Since releasing the magic from the Heart of Etheria, most of the old entrances have been blocked by rusting structures that couldn't withstand the force of the magical surge. Adora has to find Scorpia quickly if she wants to speak to her before Catra arrives.

It took a while for Adora to locate where Scorpia was but Adora eventually found her in Horror Hall, or should she say *'Honour Hall'*. It was recently renamed after Scorpia reclaimed her kingdom. They're still trying to decide on a more official name for the Scorpion Kingdom rather than the Fright Zone, but Scorpia knew instantly what she wanted to call this area. After she found out the truth about how the Horde really acquired her kingdom, Scorpia felt it only fitting to honour those who once ruled and fought to protect its original settlement. Scorpia came to learn that sad truth about her grandfather a few months ago. The royals and their people had fought a glorious battle against the Horde, but after losing his daughter and her wife to Shadow Weavers tactics, Scorpia's grandfather felt it was better to surrender and pledge his allegiance to the Horde if it meant that he could keep his granddaughter safe.

Scorpia was moving some of the debris from the area, trying to work out what repair work needed to be completed. As far as Adora was led to believe, Scorpia had offered to make her

kingdom a refuge for ex-Horde members who wanted a fresh start in life. After all it was home for many. Many soldiers had lived there as orphans all their life, just like Catra and Adora themselves. Much work still needed to be done but small progress was a good start.

"Hey Scorpia. Need a hand?" Adora asks as she crosses over to Scorpia, helping her lift a heavy piece of metal to the side wall.

"Oh hey Adora. Thanks. That piece was heavier than I though. What are you doing here anyway? I thought you had plans for today?" Scorpia replies in a happy tone, a big smile appearing on her face.

"Well I do but I wanted to ask you something first."

"Sure. Ask away. Oh now you mention it I remember Catra saying something about you coming to see me at some point today."

Wait, Catra's here, already?

Almost as if Scorpia can read Adora's panicking mind she instantly try to puts her fears to rest… "Oh don't worry. Catra's not here. Well I mean she is *here* but she's not *here* as in here, right now, in this room, with us. We spoke for a while. She seems concerned about something. She said she was mainly worried about you as you had been acting out of the ordinary all day and you seemed anxious about something. I said you might just have something on your mind and I'm sure you'll tell her when you're ready to tell her about it. Sometime you might just need some time to clear your head. She left about five minutes ago with Melog, saying that there was something of old she wanted to go see."

Something of old? Adora knows exactly where Catra is. The quicker she speaks to Scorpia the sooner she can go and find Catra.

"Catra's not wrong you know. Something has been on my mind all day. I plan on telling her soon, like *really soon* but I need to ask you something first."

Adora's hand falls to her wing pin like is has all day when it came to talking about this moment. She can't see why Scorpia would say no to her request but she still feels like she should ask Scorpia first.

"I'm going to propose to Ca…"

Before Adora can even finish her sentence, Scorpia lifts her up in to a extremely tight hug. Scorpia squeals with joy, whereas Adora desperately tries to catch her breath.

"Oh my gosh! This is amazing! I'm so happy for you two." Scorpia says as she squeezes Adora slightly tighter. Catra really wasn't exaggerating when Catra named Scorpia's hugs *'bone crushing'*.

"Sc-Scorpia. Do you think you could maybe put me down please. I'm s-struggling to *breathe.*"

"Oh shoot, sorry." Scorpia laughs nervously as she gently places Adora back on the ground... "Sorry. I sometimes forget how strong I am."

Adora rubs her side trying to sooth the ache left behind. She's definitely going to find a bruise there in the morning. She giggles slight before reassuring Scorpia that… "It's okay. I like your hugs. You're just really strong. Good competition for She-Ra I can tell you that."

Scorpia giggles at that remark. In a one on one battle She-Ra and Scorpia would be easily matched.

"Anyway, what can I do to help Adora? I won't lie, I'm kind of surprised you've come to me if you want to ask for help proposing to Catra. We all know how long it took me to figure out Perfume was flirting with me."

It was quite funny when Scorpia realised that Perfuma was flirting with her. At first she thought Perfuma was just being nice to her. Adora though *she* was clueless with this kind of stuff but even she knew what Perfuma was up to.

"Well it's more of a case of *'I want to ask you for permission to use a certain area of the Fright Zone to propose to Catra'* kind of thing. I'm planning on proposing at the top of the watch tower. We used to climb up there all the time as kids. It was our little secret hide out. We shared many memories up there together. Many nights talking about... *whatever*. To me it feels like it'll be the perfect place to propose to her."

Scorpia looks at Adora with sparkles in her eyes... "Awwwww. That's so sweet and not to mention romantic. But why are you asking me permission to propose up there?"

"Well this is your kingdom. I wanted to make sure that you are okay with me doing this here as technically you rule this place now."

Scorpia's jaw drops and at first Adora worries that she might have said something wrong. That is until Scorpia's smile returns. She walks forwards and places her claws on either side of Adora's shoulders.

"This might be my kingdom now Adora, but this once was and always will be your home. Yours and Catra's home to be exact. You shared so many memories here. Sure some were bad but many were good, but regardless of that this is your home. The place where both of your stories began. I think it would be very romantic to start the next chapter of your story together here, in the place that holds many special memories that you both cherish."

That's all the Adora needs to hear to put the final part of her plan in motion… "Thanks Scorpia."

"Anytime. Now go get your Wildcat. I have my pincers crossed for you."

Scorpia gently bats Adora on her shoulder and with that off she goes in search of Catra. Adora is ready, she can do this. All she

has to do know is find Catra and start the next chapter of their story.

--

It doesn't take long for Adora to find Catra. She is where she thought she would be: the barracks. Not much has changed in here. The walls are still standing. The dull greenish paint still surrounds the wall even though it's starting to flake. Catra's and Adora's childhood drawing is still visible, etched in the metal bunk wall. Adora already knows what has happened to their drawing. Catra told her everything after they first visited the Fright Zone after the war ended and Adora found their drawing. It still hurts her to this day, knowing how much pain and anger she caused Catra simply by leaving her behind. However, they had both learned that choices were made and their actions where theirs alone. Many things were said and done out of anger, but deep down they never gave up on each other thanks to the love that they have for one another. It took a while to heal the scars, some parts of them are still healing, but they're getting through it together.

Catra's kneeling on their old bunk, staring at the scratched drawing. Melog is sat by her side, listening to what Catra has to say. Adora stays at the door, trying her best not to startle Catra and the moment between the two companions.

"I don't know how I ended up so lucky to have Adora in my life Melog. I have done so many terrible things in life, so many things that I don't think I'll ever be able to fully forgive myself for. What I don't understand is how after everything, Adora still loves me. She still loves me and she has forgiven me for everything I ever did. I wake up every morning afraid that it's all a dream. Afraid that I'm still trapped on that ship and that in a minute I'll wake up and it'll all be taken away from me. But then she kisses me, holds me

close, and promises me that it's real, that she's really there and that she loves me. That's when I know that it'll all be okay. Adora's the love of my life Melog. My soulmate, my universe, my one and only… she's *my Adora.*"

In that moment, all of Adora's worries, all of Adora's fears about how the next moments will go disappear. She wants this, she wants Catra. She knows that she's going to spend the rest of her life with this amazing person. Catra is her soulmate, her universe, her one and only… she's *her Catra.*

Adora fully enters the room, making her presence known to both Melog and Catra. Catra doesn't turn around but her sensitive ears swivel backwards and the tip of her tail gently sways behind her. Melog on the other hand meows and walks up to Adora, leaning themselves up against her leg. Adora could have sworn they were saying *"good luck"* to her before they disappeared into the corridors. They're probably going to find Swift Wind or join Scorpia.

Adora sits besides Catra and pulls her into her lap. She wraps her arms around Catra's waist and places a gentle kiss to her cheek. Catra nuzzles herself into Adora's warmth and begins to purr.

"I've missed you." Catra says.

"It's only been a few hours."

"Yeah but a few hours to me feels like a lifetime."

Both Catra and Adora both start to softly hum. They're comfy, content, relaxed. They stay there for a few more minutes, warm with each other's company. Adora knows she'll need to say something to Catra sooner rather than later. She plans on proposing at sunset, which is Catra's favourite time of day. If they leave it too late it'll be too dark. Well, too dark for Adora to see that is. Catra will have no problem seeing with her Magicat vision.

Adora places a soft kiss to Catra's cheek before moving Catra out of her lap so that she can stand. Catra *'murps'* in protest but takes

Adora's hand and stands beside her. Her tail wraps around Adora's leg and she rest's her head against her shoulder.

"So how was your day? Are you going to tell me what adventures you've been on?"

Adora knows exactly what Catra's up to, but she doesn't plan on letting it slip. At least not just yet anyway.

"I'll tell you everything real soon but first I thought we could have a little bit of fun whilst we're here. You know for old times' sake."

"What do you have in mind?"

"I thought we could have a little race to out secret spot. Maybe watch the sunset over the Fright Zone like we used to. Only this time we don't have to run back to the barracks before lights out. We can stay up there for as long as we want."

Catra pretends to look as if she is in deep thought about that. She looks to Adora with a devilish smirk on her face. Adora knows that look all too well… "That sounds like a great idea." Catra pushes Adora into the wall and starts her sprint towards the exit and down the corridors… "race you there!"

Adora is in a fit of laughter. "Hey! That's cheating!"

Adora starts her pursuit after the love of her life. It's now or never.

--

****Now****

And now they're here at the top of the watch tower, face to face, hand in hand, heart to heart. Adora's certain the only reason she managed to get up here before Catra was because Melog tackled Catra from out of nowhere. She'd be sure to give their Krytian friend some of their favourite treats tomorrow for helping her out with this. She'd be sure to get everyone who helped her prepare for today as little something as thanks.

"Catra… I need to ask you something."

Adora can do this. She is ready. The love of her life, her Catra, looks to her full love and support. All Adora has to do is speak from the heart…

"Catra, I have loved you long before I even knew what love was. You are the best thing that ever happened to me. I was scared and alone until I found you: this tiny, beautiful Magicat kitten in a small box in the Fright Zone corridors. I knew from that moment on that we would be best friends. It's only as I got older and these new, scary feelings started to kick in, that I hoped that we could one day be something more than friends. I was too scared back then to tell you how I truly felt about you. As the years went on, no matter how far apart we were from each other, the love that I had for you grew stronger. I thought I lost you at one point Catra. My world completely shattered. But when I got you back, when I got to hold you again for the first time in three years, I promised myself that I would never, ever let you go again. I knew from that moment for sure that I couldn't live without you. Our first kiss sealed it all for me. I was yours and you were mine."

Catra has tears in her eye. Adora would be lying if she didn't say that she was the same. Adora can sense that Catra wants to say something but she's holding back from doing so. Instead, she rests her forehead against Adora's, something that they have always done that brings comfort to each other when words fail. Adora brushes smooth circular patterns over Catra's hands and continues to speak after a few deep breathes.

“You are my everything Catra. My soulmate, my universe, the love of my life. We have shared many wonderful memories together, many beautiful moments together and shared many promises. I want to add to all of them, I want to create more moments, more memories and more promises together with you. So Catra, I want to ask you something from my heart…”

Adora removes her wing pin badge from her belt and places it in Catra’s hand before gently closing her hand over the pin. She then looks in Catra’s eyes, full of love and hope. She slowly gets down on one knee. Catra’s eyes brim with tears but her gorgeous smile shines even brighter.

“Catra, will you marry me?”

Before Adora has any time to react, Catra’s pounces forward and her lips are sealed with Adora’s. Adora only just manages to stop them both from falling to the floor. The kiss is heated, passionate and loving. They only break for a few second to get some air.

“I’m guessing that’s a yes then?” Adora asks smiling brightly.

Catra laughs through her happy tears… “Oh course I’ll marry you dummy. I love you. I always have… and I always will.”

Adora pulls Catra into another kiss, and another and another and another. They eventually stand and Adora attaches her wing pin, *now her fiancé’s wing pin*, onto Catra’s shirt. It rest on the left side of her shirt, slightly above Catra’s heart. The fiancé’s, *soon to be future wives*, share another passionate moment before gazing into the distance watching the sunset.

“I love you so much Catra.”

“I love you too Adora.”

End Notes

And there you have it. The first prequel story of Finding Halfmoon is out. I hope you enjoyed it. Please let me know what your thoughts are. There will be many more prequel stories and extra content chapters to come as Finding Halfmoon updates. I hope to see you soon. Happy reading.

(P.S - yes I know this prequel story takes place a year after the war ended even though I am posting this story two years after the war ended in the series. I can't be bothered to change it but it also works well when you read Finding Halfmoon. You'll see what I mean very soon).

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!